# Safe, Focused Dispensing

*Simple habits that protect accuracy, efficiency and patient safety*

## ONE BASKET. ONE PATIENT. ONE COMPLETE PROCESS.

Keep each order clearly separated and complete it before starting another.

### 1 Focus on one basket

Work on one patient's basket from start to finish. Do not begin another routine task until the basket is complete.

### 2 Avoid unnecessary interruptions

If you must stop, keep the basket secure and leave a clear status handover before moving away.

### 3 Keep the bench tidy and clean

Remove waste, loose labels and empty packaging promptly. Keep only the current basket's items in your work area.

### 4 Coordinate scanning activity

Avoid scanning new medicines into the workflow while colleagues are dispensing completed baskets, unless this has been agreed and coordinated.

### 5 Keep the workflow moving

When several baskets are ready, prioritise the ready basket closest to your workstation, unless clinical urgency or an agreed priority takes precedence.

### 6 Choose the correct bag size

Use a bag that holds the medicines securely without crushing packs. Keep refrigerated, bulky or fragile items appropriately separated.

### 7 Check labels before applying

Match the label to the correct patient and medicine. Apply it straight and securely without hiding essential pack information.

### 8 Stop and escalate discrepancies

Never bypass a failed scan, mismatch, missing item or unclear label. Pause the basket and ask the appropriate colleague for help.

### 9 Respect the ACT handover

Keep baskets awaiting an accuracy check clearly identified. Do not mix checked and unchecked items or cross role boundaries.

### 10 Finish the package properly

Add the patient's information and required notification labels, confirm the contents are secure, then seal the package.

**FINAL PAUSE: correct patient · correct medicine · correct label · correct package**

If anything does not look right, stop and ask - accuracy checks are never optional.

# Special Handling & Waste

*Extra checks for split packs, information leaflets, confidential waste and ACT handover*

## PAUSE AND FLAG ANY ITEM REQUIRING SPECIAL ATTENTION

Keep the basket clearly identified and follow the current pharmacy SOP.

### 11 Add the expiry date to split-pack medicines

When medicine is removed from its original pack or a pack is split, make sure the supplied container or label shows the correct expiry date. Use the appropriate expiry date under the product information and local SOP; never guess.

### 12 Supply the correct PIL

Include a current Patient Information Leaflet (PIL), with particular attention to controlled drugs (CDs) and antibiotics. If the original pack has been split or no leaflet is present, obtain the correct leaflet for the exact medicine, strength and formulation.

### 13 Dispose of confidential waste securely

Place patient-identifiable paperwork, labels, tokens and other confidential material in the designated confidential-waste bin. Never place confidential information in general waste or leave it on the bench.

### 14 Flag items directly when an ACT check is required

Not every controlled drug or refrigerated item requires an ACT check. When an ACT check is required for one of these items, tell the relevant staff member directly and clearly identify the item needing the check. Follow the pharmacy SOP and do not assume the check has been noticed.

## SPECIAL ITEM? IDENTIFY IT · COMMUNICATE IT · CHECK IT · RECORD IT

When an ACT check is required, flag the item directly - do not assume it has been noticed.